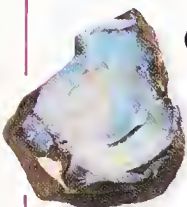




Rocks and minerals

Minerals

Rocks are made of tiny grains called minerals. Some minerals form beautiful stones.



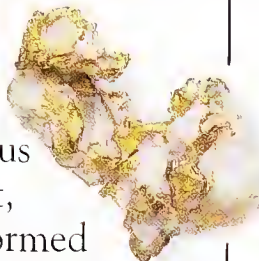
Opals are valued for their beauty.

Diamonds are the hardest of all minerals.



Jade is very hard. It is often used for carving.

Gold is a precious metal. It, too, is formed by minerals.



Copper pipe



Copper is an ore mineral. Most useful metals come from ore minerals.

Pencil



Graphite is one of the softest minerals. It is used in pencils.

The world around us is made of rock. We use rocks and minerals for many things, from buildings to jewelry.

Rock types

There are three main types of rocks. They are formed in different ways.



Conglomerate rock

Sedimentary rock

Sedimentary rock is made from layers of mud, sand, and stones that have been squashed together.



Marble

Metamorphic rock

Metamorphic rocks are sedimentary or igneous rocks that have been changed by great heat, great pressure, or both.

Did you know?

The largest diamond in the world is called the Cullinand. It is as heavy as a pineapple.



Granite



Igneous rock

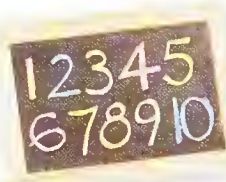
Igneous rock is made from hot, runny rock deep inside the Earth that has cooled and hardened.

Using rocks and minerals

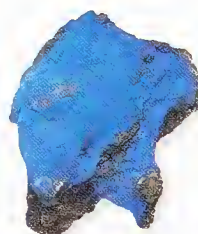
Chalk is a soft sedimentary rock used for writing.



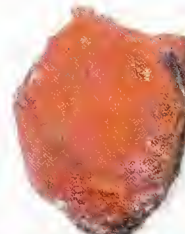
Chalkboards are made from a metamorphic rock called slate.



Paint can be made from colored minerals in rocks.



Azurite blue paint



Vermilion paint

Sculptures are often cut from igneous rocks, such as marble.



Tin cans used to be made from tin ore.

